

CONTENTS

- The answer, first
- Corrections to the brief
- 01 Business understanding
- 02 Market analysis
- 03 Competitor analysis
- 04 Positioning
- 05 Brand voice
- 06 Audiences & journeys
- 07 LinkedIn strategy
- 08 Instagram strategy
- 09 Content architecture
- 10 Export intelligence system
- 11 Daily research system
- 12 Content scoring model
- 13 Automation architecture
- 14 Content memory database
- 15 Approval workflow
- 16 Performance & learning loop
- 17 30-day editorial plan
- Sources



MAVERICK MINDS · STRATEGY DOSSIER · PREPARED 14 SEPTEMBER 2026

The Export Desk: how Maverick Minds becomes the account exporters check first

Positioning, content, research and automation strategy for an export-intelligence brand, built from current research on the market, the competitors and the incentive schemes. It covers LinkedIn, Instagram, LEAP and the scrip business.

Prepared for **Mr. V Keerthivhasan**, Maverick Minds

Status **Draft for founder review**

Research cut-off **14 Sep 2026**

Evidence labels used throughout:

FACT

verified against a source

INTERPRETATION

our reading of facts

FORECAST

a call about the future

OPINION

a judgement

VERIFY

confirm on a primary source before publishing

Why would an exporter follow Maverick Minds?

Not because it is first with the news.

Because it is first with the consequences.

Maverick Minds cannot out-speed Reuters or the Business Standard trade desk, and it cannot out-rank GTRI on national policy commentary. It doesn't need to. Every one of those sources stops at the headline. Nobody reliably does the next step: read the primary document, and work out what it does to a *specific* Indian product, destination market and manufacturing cluster, then say what an exporter should do this week.

That step is the gap, and it is wide. In 2026 alone, the rules an Indian exporter prices against changed many times over:

- US tariffs on Indian goods went from 50% to a deal at 18%, then to a temporary 10% tariff, then to a Section 301 tier.
- RoDTEP rates were halved and then restored within a month.
- The Strait of Hormuz closed to routine shipping.
- A new FEMA export regime takes effect on 1 October.

When the rules move this fast, evergreen "how to export" content goes stale quickly, and interpretation becomes the scarce thing.

Recommended positioning: *The export intelligence desk for Indian MSMEs.*

Everyone reports the headline; we work out what it does to your order book, with the source document attached.

Ten decisions this document argues for

1. **Own consequences, not scoops.** "What everyone else missed" becomes "the implication everyone else skipped". That claim is defensible every day. "We found hidden news" is not.
2. **Show receipts on every post.** Each intelligence post names its primary source (the notification number, the Federal Register document, the ePing ID). This alone separates Maverick Minds from 90% of export content.
3. **Keep a public Calls Ledger.** Log every forward-looking flag, revisit it on a set date, and grade it in public. No one in Indian export content does this. It turns claims into a track record.
4. **Put the founder first on LinkedIn.** Mr. Keerthivhasan is the byline and the face, as *the analyst*, not a guru. The company page is the archive and home of the newsletter.
5. **Research daily, publish five days a week.** Post five times a week, plus a Saturday brief, rather than seven thin posts. A quality floor beats a streak.
6. **Lean on four signature franchises** for about 80% of output: *The Fine Print*, *Second Order*, *Countdown* and *Headline vs Reality*.
7. **Separate the scrip desk from the intelligence feed, and disclose.** It is also a business with policy risk: RoDTEP's current extension ends on **30 SEP 2026** and its FY27 budget was cut 45%.

8. **Narrow LEAP.** Build it for business owners who already make or trade something and want their first export shipment done properly. Don't build it for "side-income" seekers. Run it as a cohort, not a video library.
9. **Give Instagram a different job.** It explains, in Tamil and English, and feeds LEAP. It never copies LinkedIn. WhatsApp becomes the owned channel, because that is where MSME owners actually read.
10. **Automate the research, never the judgement.** Machines collect, deduplicate, triage, score and draft. A human picks the story, checks the claims and approves. Nothing auto-publishes.

Corrections and additions to the brief

The brief asked me to correct anything technically incomplete. These points matter for both content accuracy and the scrip business. Where I relied on secondary sources, the item carries a Verify label.

BRIEF SAYS / IMPLIES	WHAT RESEARCH SHOWS	LABEL
Scrips are "traded"	RoDTEP and RoSCTL credit is issued as an e-scrip in an electronic duty-credit ledger on ICEGATE. Transfer is IEC-to-IEC. The transferor enters the transferee's ICEGATE ID and IEC, and both sides confirm by OTP. There is no exchange: price is negotiated privately, typically a small discount to face value (secondary sources cite roughly 2–4%). ICEGATE Advisory 06/2021 (rev. 5 Jan 2024); pricing from market blogs, not official	FACT VERIFY PRICE
Importers use scrips toward "applicable import-duty obligations"	Narrower than that. Duty credit pays only duty leviable under the First Schedule to the Customs Tariff Act, 1975, i.e. Basic Customs Duty. It cannot pay IGST or other levies. So scrip demand is tied to how much BCD importers pay. Every FTA that cuts BCD (UK CETA in force 15 JUL 2026; the EU FTA to follow) and every Budget BCD cut shrinks that demand over time. Notification 24/2023-Customs (N.T.); ICEGATE advisory	FACT INTERPRETATION
Scheme is a stable service line	RoDTEP has run on short extensions: - Notification 60/2025-26 halved rates and value caps on 23 FEB 2026, except HS chapters 01–24. - Notification 66/2025-26 restored them on 23 MAR 2026, citing the maritime situation. - Notification 74/2025-26 extended the scheme to 30 SEP 2026 for DTA, AA, SEZ and EOU exports. FY27 allocation was cut to ₹10,000 crore from ₹18,233 crore. RoSCTL is extended to 30 SEP 2026 "or until approval of the Scheme for the 16th Finance Commission cycle, whichever is earlier". I found no announcement on what follows 30 September as of 14 September.	FACT CHECK DAILY
Scrips are valid for a year	Secondary sources report validity was changed from 1 year to 2 years from creation in the ledger by a CBIC amendment to the Electronic Duty Credit Ledger Regulations (Sept 2022). Unused credit lapses after that.	VERIFY ON CBIC
Buyer risk is low	The 14 Sept 2022 amendments to Notifications 76/2021 and 77/2021 removed recovery from the transferee for excess credit; recovery now runs against the exporter. That followed Delhi HC W.P.(C) 11178/2022. Fraud-linked recovery under Section 28AAA also runs against the person to whom the instrument was issued. Buyer-side due diligence is still good practice: check the scrip is active and not suspended.	FACT VERIFY CURRENT TEXT
"Export incentive"	Officially RoDTEP is a remission of embedded, un-refunded taxes: fuel duty, electricity duty, mandi tax and similar. The framing matters: US Commerce has treated RoDTEP as countervailable in several CVD cases against Indian products (e.g. paper file folders, 2023). So Maverick Minds content should never call it a "subsidy" or "free money".	FACT
(not in brief) Compliance	An Annual RoDTEP Return (ARR) is mandatory for IECs claiming more than ₹1 crore a year. Late filing attracts composition fees, and missing it suspends benefits. Duty credit is also conditional on realising export proceeds within the FEMA period, or it is recovered with interest. GST on transferring duty credit scrips is nil (entry 122A, Notification 35/2017-CT(Rate)).	FACT

CHALLENGE • THE SCRIP BUSINESS

The scrip line depends on three things Maverick Minds doesn't control:

- the scheme continuing past 30 SEP 2026
- its budget, now cut 45%
- importers' BCD bills, which FTAs are steadily shrinking

It should be run as one part of a broader **Incentive Desk**, covering ARR filing, realisation compliance, drawback and Export Promotion Mission support, not as the brand's commercial core. Part 4 covers why it should also be kept out of the intelligence feed.

Business understanding

Maverick Minds looks like one company but runs four businesses. Each has a different buyer, different economics and a different relationship to trust. The strategy has to be built around that fact.

ENGINE	WHO PAYS	ECONOMICS	WHAT IT NEEDS FROM THE BRAND	MAIN RISK
Education offline programmes → LEAP	Aspiring exporters, business owners, colleges	One-to-many and scalable once online; price-competitive market	Proof that the teacher knows the <i>current</i> reality, not 2019's	Pulled into the "earn from exports" hype market, which damages everyone else's trust
Advisory MSME consulting	Existing and export- ready MSMEs	High ticket, limited by founder time, relationship-led	Visible depth: specific, correct, sector-aware thinking	Founder bandwidth; hard to scale
Incentive & scrip desk	Two sides: exporters (sellers) and importers (buyers)	Transactional; thin spread; needs speed, trust and counterparties	Reliability and discretion, <i>not</i> reach	Scheme continuity, budget cuts, shrinking BCD base, and conflict of interest if mixed with commentary
Intelligence latent today	No one yet	Cost centre now; the reputation engine for the other three; possibly a paid tier later	Accuracy, a consistent cadence, a track record	One badly wrong call on a policy detail

INTERPRETATION The key insight: **intelligence is the only content type that is valuable to every one of these buyers at once.**

- The MSME uses it.
- The importer cares about it because it moves their duty bill.
- The beginner is impressed by it: it shows them the teacher is operating in the real market.

Beginner education content, by contrast, repels experienced exporters. Scrip promotion repels everyone who isn't transacting that week. So intelligence becomes the brand's spine. Education and services hang off it.

Home turf

Maverick Minds is based in Coimbatore, according to its public website and the founder's public LinkedIn profile. That puts it inside one of India's densest export-manufacturing belts:

- Tirupur knitwear, Karur home textiles and Erode turmeric
- Coimbatore pumps, motors and castings
- Namakkal eggs, Ambur and Vellore leather, and Tuticorin marine products

National intelligence voices are Delhi-centric and national in lens. A credible **cluster lens** ("what this means for Tirupur") is an asset Maverick Minds can own without pretending to be national on day one.

The five strategic risks

1. **Founder bandwidth.** The founder cannot be researcher, writer, consultant, trainer and deal-maker. The research system (Parts 10–13) exists to take

research and first drafts off his plate.

2. **Accuracy risk.** An intelligence brand can be destroyed by one confident, wrong claim about a notification. The approval workflow (Part 15) is designed around this.
3. **Hype contagion.** If LEAP's marketing borrows the "lakhs per month from exports" register of the mass-market trainers, it undercuts the intelligence brand.
4. **Policy dependency.** See the scrip note above.
5. **Conflict of interest.** Commenting on RoDTEP while earning on RoDTEP transfers is legitimate only with disclosure and separation.

Market analysis: the export content landscape

Why 2026 favours an intelligence brand

FACT The operating environment for Indian exporters has become unusually volatile this year. The list below is itself the best argument for the positioning.

DEVELOPMENT	STATUS (AS RESEARCHED)	WHY EXPORTERS FEEL IT
US tariffs on India	The Feb 2026 deal cut the rate from 50% to 18%. When Section 122 lapsed, a Section 301 two-tier tariff took effect on 24 JUL 2026, with India in the 10% tier. BTA talks continue: Goyal says India will close only when it gets a "preferential rate in comparison to our competition". A G20 trade ministerial opens 30 SEP 2026.	Landed-cost maths versus Vietnam, Bangladesh and China changes with every step
Strait of Hormuz	Largely blocked since 28 FEB 2026; reported effectively closed to routine shipping from 30 JUL 2026; attacks continuing into September	Gulf-bound freight, war-risk cover and transit times. ICRA estimated about 14% of India's exports are linked to West Asia.
RoDTEP / RoSCTL	Rates halved and then restored; extension ends 30 SEP 2026; FY27 budget ₹10,000 cr	Price quotes for October shipments
FEMA export regime	New FEMA (Export and Import of Goods and Services) Regulations, 2026 take effect 1 OCT 2026: 15-month realisation (18 for INR invoices), a unified EDF, liberalised set-off. The old regime was reset to 9 months on 5 JUN 2026 for the transition.	Payment terms, bank paperwork, receivable risk
India–UK CETA	In force 15 JUL 2026. UK steel safeguard tightened; UK CBAM from 1 JAN 2027.	New margins for textiles, leather, marine, engineering; new costs for steel
India–EU FTA	Concluded Jan 2026; Commission proposed signature to the Council in Sept 2026; entry into force expected early 2027	Rules-of-origin preparation window is now
EU CBAM	Definitive phase from 1 Jan 2026; certificates for 2026 imports are bought from Feb 2027	EU buyers already pricing a carbon cost into steel and aluminium orders
EUDR	Applies 30 DEC 2026 to large and medium operators; 30 JUN 2027 to micro and small. Leather proposed for exclusion.	Coffee and rubber exporters get geolocation and due-diligence requests

INTERPRETATION In a stable year, "how exporting works" content holds its value for a long time. In a year like this one, a large share of the practical questions exporters ask has an answer that changed in the last 90 days. **Interpretation of change is the scarce good.** Very few players are set up to produce it.

What the market already produces: saturation map

TOPIC OR FORMAT	SATURATION	WHY	MAVERICK MINDS MOVE
"How to start an export business", IEC registration, "zero-investment export"	Very high	Core funnel of every mass-market trainer; big YouTube and Instagram libraries	Don't compete head-on. Cover only through a "reality check" lens on Instagram.
"Top 10 products to export from India"	Very high	Easy listicle; rarely backed by data; often stale	Replace with data-backed <i>Market Door</i> posts on one HS code and one market
"What is RoDTEP / Incoterms / LC" explainers	High (SEO)	Fintechs and consultancies (Skydo, Xflow, Razorpay, EximPe, Afleo, Rasp) own Google for these queries	Explain mechanics only when news makes them urgent (news-pegged explainers)
Notification screenshot + "BIG UPDATE"	High	Tax portals (TaxGuru, Taxscan) and LinkedIn reposters	Same document, but lead with the consequence and the action
FTA celebration posts ("99% of lines duty-free!")	High	Amplification of official messaging	<i>Headline vs Reality</i> : which lines actually gained margin, against whom, and under what rules of origin

TOPIC OR FORMAT	SATURATION	WHY	MAVERICK MINDS MOVE
US tariff headline recaps	High	Every business page	Relative-tariff analysis: India's rate versus competitor countries, per product
Foreign draft regulations (WTO ePing SPS/TBT), EU RASFF alerts, US FDA refusals, Federal Register trade-remedy notices	Very low	Requires reading foreign primary sources systematically	Core franchise territory: <i>Draft Watch</i> , <i>Rejection Watch</i> , <i>Second Order</i>
Cluster-level implications (Tirupur, Karur, Coimbatore...)	Very low	National voices don't; local trainers do beginner content	Cluster lens on every relevant story
Accountability for past predictions	None found	Nobody keeps score	The Calls Ledger

Overused claims (avoid all of them)

"No.1 export trainer" · "India's best" · "earn lakhs from home" · "guaranteed buyers" · "zero investment" · "100% practical" · "real exporter" as a trust badge · "Nobody is talking about this" · "BIG UPDATE" · "game-changer". Mass-market education sites lean on scale claims: one prominent trainer's site cites 730,000+ YouTube subscribers and 51,000+ students. That arms race is lost before it starts. Credibility has to come from *specificity*, not size.

Competitor analysis

The useful unit of analysis is the *archetype*, not individual accounts. Each archetype occupies a position; the gaps between them are where Maverick Minds fits.

ARCHETYPE	EXAMPLES (VERIFIED TO EXIST)	WHAT THEY DO WELL	POSITION OCCUPIED	GAP THEY LEAVE	DON'T COPY
Mass-market export trainers	Export Experts Global / Harsh Dhawan (~594K Instagram followers per search snippet); Bharat Udaan Mission (Amit Mulani); iiiEM; GFE Business; @amt.india; @exportimportindiaofficial; Tamil-language channels such as "Exports & Imports Business in Tamil"	Volume, social proof, beginner clarity, regional-language reach, community	"Start your export business", aspiration-led	Current, specific intelligence; anything useful to an existing exporter	Scale claims, "No.1", income insinuation, product-idea listicles
Policy think-tank voice	GTRI (Ajay Srivastava, ex-Indian Trade Service); FIEO commentary (e.g. weekly interactions via the Indian Trade Portal)	Authority, data, media citations, speed on national policy	National trade policy commentary for government and media	"What do I do with my HS code this week?" and cluster or MSME specificity	Trying to out-policy GTRI. Quote and extend them instead.
Fintech / SaaS content marketers	Skydo, Xflow, EximPe, Razorpay, Afleo, Rasp International, Mundhra Consulting	Well-structured SEO explainers ("RoDTEP 2026 guide")	Google search for scheme and process explainers	Timeliness, interpretation, LinkedIn-native voice	Long evergreen "guides" on LinkedIn
Tax and legal update portals	TaxGuru, Taxscan, TaxTMI, Big Four alerts, CA firms	Very fast reproduction of notifications	"The notification is out"	Commercial meaning; what it does to price, cash or market access	Reproducing notification text
Trade data vendors	Volza, Export Genius, Seair, Eximpedia and similar	Data-rich posts ("top buyers of X")	Lead-generation data	Context, verification, the "so what"	Unverified "top buyer" lists
News media	ET, Business Standard, Mint, FE, BusinessLine, Fibre2Fashion, Maritime Gateway	Speed, access, official quotes	What happened	What it means for a specific exporter	Competing on speed
Scrip dealers	Many brokers advertising "best rates"	Transaction speed	A commodity service	Trust and compliance advice around the scrip	Rate-card posts in a brand feed

Strategic patterns

1. **Education competes on scale and aspiration.** That drives a race toward louder claims and lower prices. A premium, honest position is open at the top: "we teach the current reality, taught by people who work in it daily".
2. **Intelligence competes on national policy** and is written for policymakers and journalists. Nobody translates it down to HS code, market, cluster and action.
3. **Everyone reacts to Indian announcements and big US headlines.** Almost nobody mines *foreign primary sources* (ePing drafts, RASFF, FDA refusals, Federal Register, EU Official Journal) for Indian implications. That is where the "saw it first" moments actually come from.
4. **No one keeps score.** A public ledger of calls is the single most differentiating trust device available.
5. **Regional depth exists only at beginner level.** A cluster-aware intelligence voice is an empty slot.

RESEARCH LIMITATION

Follower counts above come from search snippets. I could not measure engagement rates, because LinkedIn and Instagram need a logged-in session.

Before finalising franchise priorities, run a **14-day audit**:

- Pick about 15 accounts across the archetypes.
- Log every post's topic, format and hook, plus reactions, comments and reposts.
- Sample 20 commenters per account to see *who* engages (exporter, student, vendor).

The database in Part 14 includes a `competitor_posts` table for exactly this.

Positioning

Testing "finding what everyone else missed"

What works

- It fits the name. "Maverick" earns meaning.
- It is rare in the category.
- It creates a reason to check the account daily.

What breaks

- Taken literally, it's a speed race you lose to wires and GTRI.
- It invites clickbait ("nobody is talking about this...").
- It is unfalsifiable until the day you miss something, and then it's embarrassing.
- Contrarian takes on policy are a reputational risk.

OPINION Keep the spirit and change the claim. Maverick Minds shouldn't claim to find hidden news. It should claim to find the **hidden implication** and the **buried document**. The headline is public; the second-order consequence for an Indian exporter usually isn't. That claim can be proved daily, and it survives an off day.

"Maverick" gets a precise, credible meaning: **independent reading**. In practice that means four behaviours:

1. We read the primary source, not the press release about it.
2. We say so when the fine print disagrees with the headline, including when the headline is the government's.
3. We write our calls down and grade them in public.
4. We say "we don't know yet" when we don't.

Positioning statement

For Indian MSME exporters and export-ready manufacturers who can't afford a trade-policy team, **Maverick Minds is the export intelligence desk** that reads the primary documents of global trade and works out what they mean for your product, your market and your next contract. News reports, trainers teach the basics and think-tanks advise governments. **We turn signals into exporter decisions, with receipts.**

Brand promise

Every week, at least one development that should change an Indian exporter's decisions. Sourced to the document, mapped to the product and market, with a clear "what to do".

Line options

- **Global trade, worked out for Indian exporters.** (primary)
- Before it's news, it's a notification. (intelligence franchise line)
- Everyone reports the headline. We read the fine print.

Proof points to build

- Source line on every post
- The Calls Ledger
- Public corrections
- Cluster and HS specificity
- Citations by EPCs, associations and media over time

Brand architecture

LAYER	NAME	ROLE	WHERE IT SHOWS UP
Masterbrand	Maverick Minds	Export intelligence and education	Everywhere
Reputation engine	The Maverick Desk	Daily intelligence; franchises; the Saturday <i>Maverick Brief</i>	Founder LinkedIn, company page, newsletter, WhatsApp channel
Scalable product	LEAP — Learn. Earn. And Progress.	Cohort programme for export-ready businesses	Instagram, webinars, newsletter, colleges (B2B)
High-trust service	Maverick Advisory	MSME export strategy and implementation	Inbound from the Desk; referrals
Transactional service	Incentive Desk (includes scrip facilitation)	RoDTEP/RoSCTL monetisation, ARR, realisation and drawback compliance, EPM guidance	WhatsApp Business, direct outreach, partner CHAs and CAs. <i>Not</i> the main feed.

CHALLENGE • SHOULD SCRIP TRADING BE SEPARATED?

Yes: in channel, in voice and with disclosure. But not in legal entity, for now.

- "Maximum value! Immediate settlement!" rate posts next to a careful analysis of a DGFT notification make the analysis look like a sales funnel.
- Any Desk post about RoDTEP/RoSCTL carries a one-line disclosure: *"Disclosure: Maverick Minds facilitates RoDTEP/RoSCTL scrip transfers."* Disclosing openly is itself a trust signal.
- The Desk never makes calls on scheme continuation that could read as manipulating scrip prices. It reports the documents and the scenarios.

Founder or company?

INTERPRETATION Founder-led, with the company as institution. Reasons:

1. LinkedIn distribution strongly favours personal profiles over company pages. Third-party 2026 analyses consistently report several times the engagement. Treat the exact multiples as unverified, but the direction is not in dispute.
2. Intelligence needs an accountable name. "Keerthivhasan says" can be held to account. "Maverick Minds says" is anonymous.
3. Offline programmes already built trust in the *person*, and that trust transfers online through his face and voice.

The company page still matters. It is the archive, the newsletter's home, the place a banker or buyer checks, and the vehicle for posts that aren't opinion (data charts, the Ledger, event notes). As the team grows, add a second byline (e.g. a research analyst) so the Desk is visibly *more than one person*, which protects the brand from single-person dependency.

Brand voice guide

The character: a senior export manager who also reads the Gazette.

Unhurried, specific, commercially minded. He explains the way you'd explain to a smart client across a desk, not to a classroom.

DIMENSION	SETTING	IN PRACTICE
Authority	High on facts; measured on interpretation	State facts flatly, with the source. Mark interpretation as interpretation.
Informality	Low–medium	First person ("I read the notification so you don't have to" is fine). No slang, no emoji in LinkedIn text, no exclamation marks.
Opinion strength	Clear, bounded	"I'd price October orders as if RoDTEP is zero" is good. "The government is destroying exporters" is off-brand.
Sentence style	Short declaratives; one idea per line; concrete nouns	Name the notification, the HS code, the port, the date. Avoid abstractions like "the landscape", "the ecosystem".
Numbers	Precise and sourced	Always give unit, period and source ("₹10,000 crore, FY27 allocation, Union Budget"). Round only when you say so.
Politics	Neutral on parties; candid on policy mechanics	Critique the design of a rule, never a party or a person.

The uncertainty ladder

Uncertainty is stated with fixed words, so readers learn the scale:

- **Confirmed** — in a notified document.
- **Reported** — credible media, not yet notified.
- **Likely** — our read, most evidence points one way.
- **Possible** — a scenario worth preparing for.
- **Unclear** — we don't know, and here is what would tell us.

Headlines and hooks

Hook philosophy: the first line states a specific consequence, not a feeling.

Specificity is the hook.

NOT THIS

🔔 BIG UPDATE for exporters!! Nobody is talking about this...

THIS

From 1 October, your bank gives you 15 months to realise an export, not 9. Here's what else changes in the new FEMA rules.

NOT THIS

India–UK FTA is a game-changer for Indian exporters!

THIS

UK duty on Indian knitwear is now zero. Against Bangladesh, that changes nothing. Here's where it does matter.

NOT THIS

Hormuz crisis: exporters face huge losses 😞

THIS

If you're quoting CIF to a Gulf buyer this month, you're underwriting war-risk you can't price. Switch the Incoterm, not the buyer.

These examples illustrate voice only. Each needs the verification noted in the 30-day plan before it runs as real copy.

Post anatomy (intelligence posts)

1. **Consequence line** — who is affected, and how.
2. **What changed** — two or three lines of fact.
3. **What it means** — interpretation, labelled as such.
4. **Who should care** — HS codes, markets, clusters.
5. **What to do this week** — one to three actions.
6. **What we're watching** — the next trigger, with a date if possible.
7. **Source line** — document, number, date.

Vocabulary

Use

notified · in force · effective
from · landed cost · realisation
· rules of origin · margin of
preference · exposure · HS line
· buyer ask · window · watch
for · the fine print says

Avoid

game-changer · huge
opportunity · must-know ·
hidden secret · nobody is
talking about · guaranteed ·
passive income · explode ·
skyrocket · "Let that sink in" ·
"Agree?" · 🚀 💰 🔥

Never, without a source

tariff rates · scheme rates or
deadlines · trade values ·
quotes · company names in
any negative context ·
"government is planning..."

Corrections policy (part of the voice)

Mistakes get corrected in public: edit the post, add a first comment starting "Correction:", and log it in the Ledger. An intelligence brand that corrects itself visibly is *more* trusted, not less.

Audience segmentation and journeys

PRIORITY	SEGMENT	WHAT THEY NEED	WHAT THEY'D PAY FOR	FIRST CONTENT THAT WORKS	CHANNEL
1	Existing MSME exporters owner, director, export manager; ₹5–250 cr turnover	Early warning; margin protection; compliance certainty	Advisory; Incentive Desk (they generate scrips); LEAP for their team	Countdown, Fine Print, Second Order	LinkedIn, WhatsApp, newsletter
2	Export-ready domestic businesses manufacturers and traders with a product, no exports yet	A safe, ordered path to the first shipment	LEAP (core buyer); first-shipment advisory	Headline vs Reality, news-pegged explainers, Market Door	LinkedIn, Instagram, webinars
3	Importers (BCD payers)	Lower duty cost; FTA and duty changes	Scrip purchase; duty and FTA advisory	Duty-change Fine Print; FTA rules-of-origin posts	Direct B2B outreach, LinkedIn (targeted), CHA partners
4	Serious aspiring exporters professionals, second-generation family members, entrepreneurs with capital and a plan	Real understanding, protection from scams	LEAP Foundation (filtered)	Instagram "reality check" and scam-awareness series	Instagram, YouTube, webinars
5	Colleges and students	Career awareness; practical trade literacy	Institutions pay (campus LEAP); students rarely do	Campus sessions; the Desk as a live teaching resource	B2B to colleges; Instagram
Multiplier	CHAs, freight forwarders, CAs, trade-finance bankers, EPC and association staff	Something useful to forward to their clients	Referral partnerships	Countdowns and compliance checklists they can share	LinkedIn, WhatsApp
Deprioritise	"Side-income / zero-investment" seekers; general business-motivation audiences	Shortcuts	Low willingness to pay; high refund and complaint risk	—	Filter out

CHALLENGE · SHOULD LEAP TARGET A NARROWER AUDIENCE?

Yes. The mass beginner market already has scaled incumbents with hundreds of thousands of followers, large student counts and aggressive pricing. Competing there means adopting their register, which contradicts the intelligence brand.

The underserved buyer is the **owner of an existing business who has a product and wants the first export done right**. They will pay more, finish the course, become exporters, and later need advisory and incentive services. They also generate scrips.

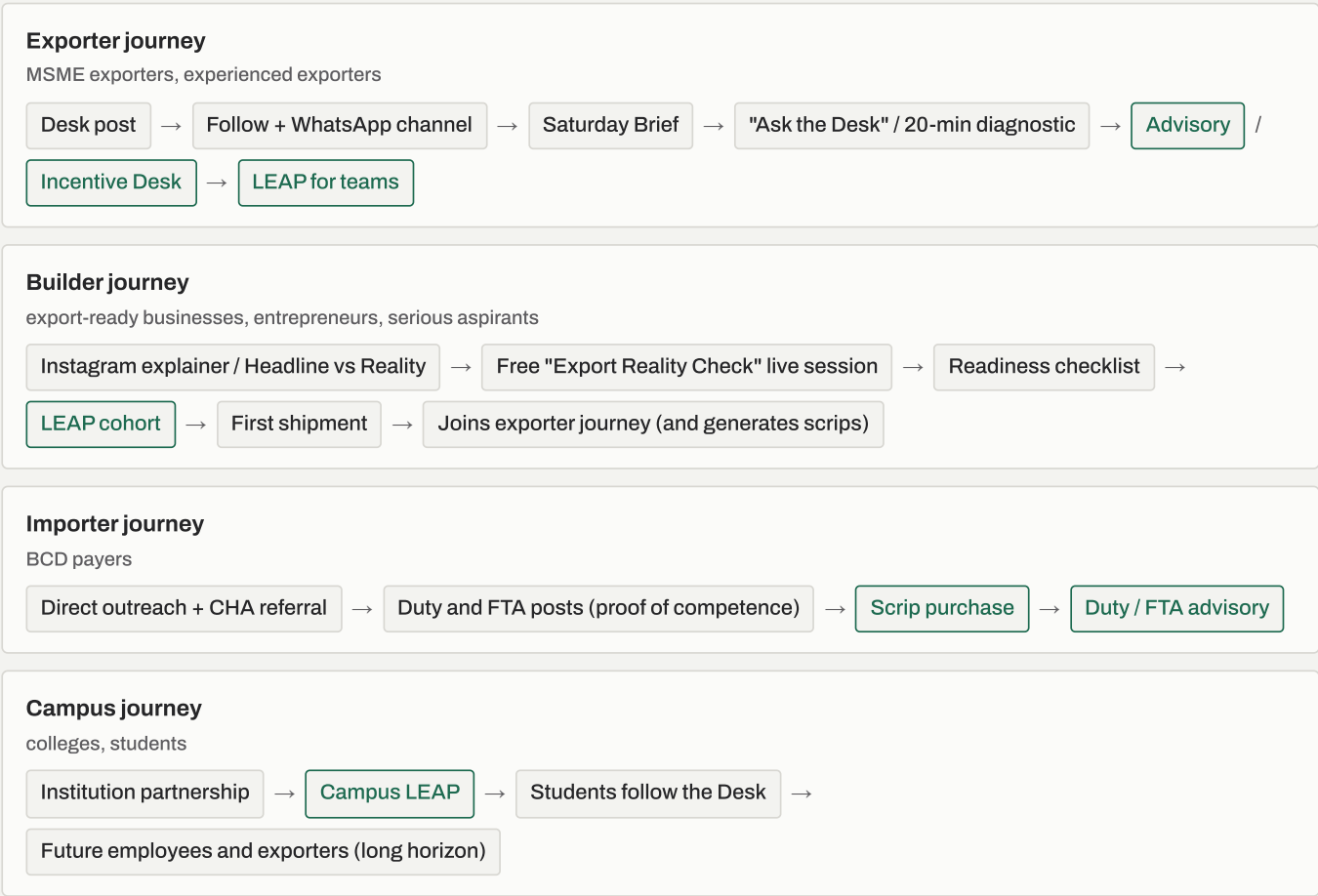
LEAP's promise should be concrete: *"In eight weeks, go from 'my product could sell abroad' to a costed, compliant, buyer-ready export plan, with your first qualified buyer conversations under way."* No income claims, no guaranteed buyers.

Keep "Earn" in the name, but define it as *earning your first export order properly*, never as an income promise.

Journeys, not one funnel

The brief proposes one path: Research → Content → Attention → Trust → Community → LEAP → Consultation → Scrip services. OPINION **That path is not logical for most people.** Scrip *sellers* are existing exporters. They will never come through a beginner course. Scrip *buyers* are importers, a different

audience again. And LEAP buyers are mostly not advisory clients. Four journeys share one trust core instead:



INTERPRETATION The loop worth noticing: builder-journey graduates who start exporting become exporter-journey clients and scrip sellers. That makes LEAP a long-term supply channel for the other businesses, which is the real reason to keep it serious.

Journey notes per audience named in the brief

AUDIENCE	ENTRY POINT	WHAT BUILDS TRUST	NATURAL NEXT STEP
Complete beginners	Instagram reality-check and scam-awareness reels	Honesty about effort and risk	Free live session → LEAP Foundation only if they have a product or trade
Existing exporters	A Countdown or Fine Print post that affects their shipments	Being right early, with the source	WhatsApp channel → diagnostic → advisory or incentive work
MSMEs considering export	Headline vs Reality on an FTA covering their product	Specific numbers for <i>their</i> HS line	Readiness checklist → LEAP
Experienced exporters	Second Order and Draft Watch	Things they didn't already know	Peer discussion; advisory on new markets; they amplify the Desk
Importers interested in scrips	Direct outreach, CHA introduction	Clean, fast, documented transfers; due-diligence help	Repeat purchases; FTA duty planning
Students	Campus programme, Instagram	Clarity; career relevance	Follow; internships; long-term brand
Entrepreneurs	Market Door posts; Instagram	Data over hype	LEAP → first-shipment support
College audiences (institutions)	Offline programme track record	Structured curriculum; real-time case material	Annual campus contracts

LinkedIn strategy

Role: the reputation engine. LinkedIn is where exporters, importers, bankers, CHAs, EPC officials and journalists decide who is credible.

DECISION	RECOMMENDATION	WHY
Primary audience	MSME exporters and export managers; secondary: importers, multipliers, export-ready owners	They buy advisory and incentive services and they amplify
Primary account	Founder's profile. Company page reposts and runs the newsletter, charts and the Ledger.	Reach and accountability (Part 4)
Frequency	Five posts a week (Mon–Fri) + the Saturday <i>Maverick Brief</i> newsletter. Sunday off. Daily <i>research</i> regardless.	B2B weekend reach is low. A quality floor protects the brand.
Format mix	~40% text + one chart or annotated document image; ~30% document/PDF carousels (5–9 pages); ~15% short founder video (60–120 s); ~15% text-only (Countdowns, Ask the Desk)	Documents and native media hold attention without an outbound link; charts carry data
Length	Signal posts 150–300 words; carousels up to 9 slides; newsletter 800–1,200 words	Long enough for fact → meaning → action
Links	Source link in the <i>first comment</i> (documents) or on the last carousel slide	Keeps the post native while still showing receipts
Commercial posts	At most 1 in 10. Always useful on its own. Disclosed if scrip-related.	Protects the Desk's credibility
Comments	The founder writes 3–5 substantive comments a day on others' trade posts, adding the fine print they missed	Comments are content: a low-cost way to be discovered by the right people

Platform notes (dwell time and saves as signals, personal profiles outperforming pages, outbound links under-distributed) come from third-party 2026 analyses, not LinkedIn documentation. Treat them as hypotheses and test them against your own analytics in the first 60 days.

How the system produces something interesting every day

Weekdays are **not** fixed themes. Each day's lead post is simply the **highest-scoring story** from the scoring model (Part 12). A light default rhythm follows real data calendars, so the Desk always has a fallback:

DAY	DEFAULT SLOT (USED ONLY IF NOTHING SCORES HIGHER)	WHY THAT DAY
Mon	<i>Countdown</i> : the week's dates that change exporters' economics	Planning mindset at week start
Tue–Wed	Best <i>Fine Print</i> or <i>Second Order</i> story	Monday–Tuesday notifications, and overnight US and EU publications, have landed
Thu	<i>Freight Pulse</i> (weekly container-rate read for Indian lanes) or <i>Draft Watch</i>	Drewry's World Container Index publishes on Thursdays
Fri	<i>Headline vs Reality</i> or <i>Ask the Desk</i>	Reflective; good for discussion
Sat	<i>The Maverick Brief</i> (newsletter)	Owners read longer pieces at weekends

A backlog of 10–15 pre-researched evergreen-but-timely pieces (news-pegged explainers, Market Doors) means a quiet news day never forces filler.

Educational content versus intelligence content

Intelligence

Triggered by a change. Time-bound. Answers "what changed, and what should I do?" Carries a source line and a date.

Education (news-pegged)

Triggered by a change, but explains the underlying mechanism: why BCD is the only duty a scrip can pay; how rules of origin work. It keeps its value for months and later feeds LEAP modules.

Introducing LEAP without damaging credibility

1. **Weeks 1–6: no LEAP selling.** Build the Desk's record first.
2. **Weeks 4–8: show the curriculum being built from Desk material** ("this week's FEMA change becomes Module 6, Lesson 2"). Open a waitlist from the Saturday Brief only.
3. **Week 8+: launch the first online cohort** with a live session. Sell with specifics: the syllabus, the eight-week outcome, who it is *not* for.
4. **Offline reputation transfer:** short testimonials from past programme participants on camera (with consent); photos from real sessions; named partner institutions. No invented numbers.

Instagram strategy

Role: Instagram is the *explanation and trust* channel. It turns trade mechanics into something a first-generation business owner understands in a minute, in Tamil and English. It is LEAP's lead source. It is not the reputation engine, and it should never be a LinkedIn copy.

CHALLENGE · SHOULD INSTAGRAM MATTER MORE THAN LINKEDIN?

For LEAP lead volume, possibly yes. For the brand and for high-value revenue, no. Advisory and incentive clients decide on LinkedIn, WhatsApp and referrals. Run Instagram at a lower cadence (3–4 posts a week) with a separate content plan, and judge it on LEAP pipeline metrics, not on follower count.

DECISION	RECOMMENDATION
Formats	About 60% Reels (45–75 s, founder on camera, captions burned in); about 40% carousels (7–10 slides, built to be saved). Reels bring discovery; carousels convert followers.
Language	Primarily Tamil voice-over with English on-screen text, plus English-only editions of the best pieces. Regional-language intelligence is close to empty territory.
Founder on video	Yes. Trust in export education is trust in a person, and the audience is on guard against scams. A real face at a real desk works better than stock footage.
Visual identity	"The document on the desk". Recurring overhead shots of the actual paper (shipping bill, BL, LC, a notification) with a hand pointing to the line that matters. Brand crimson for the highlight, charcoal for text, one condensed sans. No stock cityscapes, no money imagery, no container-ship clichés.
Lead generation	Comment a keyword → automated DM with a free resource (e.g. <i>Export Readiness Checklist</i>) → WhatsApp → invitation to a free live "Export Reality Check" → LEAP
Signals to optimise	Sends (DM shares), saves, watch-through. Third-party 2026 reporting says Instagram leadership has confirmed watch time, sends-per-reach and likes-per-reach as major signals, and that original content is favoured over reposts. Verify against your own Insights.

Instagram series

Paperwork, Decoded

One export document a week: what it is, the one line people get wrong, and what that line costs them.

Is This Real?

Anatomy of export scams: fake LCs, fake "buyer" advance-fee requests, fake agents. Protective, highly shareable, builds trust with the most wary segment.

60-Second Desk

The week's best LinkedIn intelligence story, rebuilt for a beginner in one visual metaphor (a map, an invoice, a shipping route).

One Word

A trade term through a real current example (e.g. "war-risk surcharge" through the Hormuz situation).

Cluster Stories

Short documentary visits to exporting units in Tamil Nadu clusters. Only with consent, never implying income outcomes.

Reality Check

Myths about exporting answered honestly, including "who this isn't for".

What not to post on Instagram

- Screenshots of notifications or dense infographics. They don't read on a phone.
- Scrip rates or "sell your scrip" promotions. Use WhatsApp Business and direct outreach.
- Income claims, earnings screenshots, "₹X lakh a month" hooks. Beyond the trust damage, these create advertising-policy risk.
- "Top 10 products to export" listicles.
- LinkedIn text pasted into a caption.
- Geopolitical hot takes. Keep conflict topics to their practical shipping and payment consequences.

Content architecture

The minimum set that achieves the brand objective is **four categories**:

- **Signal** — the reputation engine.
- **Explain** — turns attention into understanding.
- **Proof** — turns understanding into trust.
- **Offer** — turns trust into revenue, sparingly.

Inside them sit recurring franchises. Readers learn to recognise them by name.

FRANCHISE	CATEGORY	PURPOSE	EXAMPLE TOPIC (FROM CURRENT RESEARCH)	FORMAT	FREQUENCY	FUNNEL ROLE	MAIN SOURCES	EFFORT
The Fine Print	Signal	One primary document; the line that matters	FEMA (Export and Import of Goods and Services) Regulations 2026 from 1 Oct: realisation 15 months (18 for INR invoices), unified EDF, set-off	Text + annotated document image	1–2/wk	Authority; exporter journey	DGFT, CBIC, RBI, Gazette	Medium
Second Order	Signal	Global event → which Indian products, markets and clusters win or lose	US final CVD on oleoresin paprika from India (Federal Register, 21 Aug 2026) → what US CVD practice on RoDTEP means for spice-extract exporters	Carousel with an exposure chart	1–2/wk	"Saw it first" moments	Federal Register, EU OJ, trade data	High
Countdown	Signal	Dates that change exporters' economics, with actions	RoDTEP/RoSCTL extension ends 30 Sep; FEMA 2026 on 1 Oct; EUDR 30 Dec; UK CBAM 1 Jan 2027	Text list; recurring template	Weekly (Mon)	Habit; shareable by multipliers	All primary sources	Low
Headline vs Reality	Signal	Test an official or media claim against the fine print	"99% of lines duty-free" in UK CETA: where Indian products actually gain versus competitors that already had preferences	Text + comparison table	Weekly	Differentiation; debate	FTA texts, tariff schedules	Medium–high
Draft Watch	Signal	Foreign rules still in draft (WTO ePing SPS/TBT) that buyers will ask about months later	A new pesticide residue limit or labelling rule in a key market, while the comment window is still open	Text + one visual	Fortnightly	True early warning	ePing daily alerts	Medium
Rejection Watch	Signal	What importing countries flagged or refused from India, and why	Monthly count and pattern of EU RASFF notifications and US FDA refusals for Indian products	Carousel / chart	Monthly	Practical; agri and food audiences	RASFF portal, FDA import refusals	Medium
Freight Pulse	Signal	The weekly logistics read for Indian lanes	War-risk and routing costs on Gulf-bound cargo during the Hormuz closure; Incoterm choices	Chart + 100 words	Weekly (Thu)	Habit; forwarders reshare	Drewry WCI, carrier advisories, IMF PortWatch	Low once templated
The Number	Signal	One trade statistic, interpreted	Monthly quick estimates of India's merchandise trade (mid-month release)	Single chart	Monthly	Authority	Commerce ministry, TradeStat	Low
Market Door	Explain	One HS code × one market: demand, duty, competitors, requirements	A UK CETA line where Indian goods now enter duty-free, with import data and the rules of origin	Document carousel	Fortnightly	Builder journey; LEAP material	ITC Trade Map, UN Comtrade, tariff schedules	High

FRANCHISE	CATEGORY	PURPOSE	EXAMPLE TOPIC (FROM CURRENT RESEARCH)	FORMAT	FREQUENCY	FUNNEL ROLE	MAIN SOURCES	EFFORT
News-pegged explainer	Explain	The mechanism behind today's story	Why a RoDTEP scrip can only pay Basic Customs Duty, and what that means for importers	Carousel / Reel	Weekly	Education; LEAP modules	Scheme and customs texts	Medium
Ask the Desk	Explain	Real questions from clients, students and comments (anonymised)	"If RoDTEP lapses, what happens to scrips I already hold?"	Text Q&A / short video	Weekly	Conversation; lead signals	Inbox, consultations	Low
The Calls Ledger	Proof	Grade our own past flags in public	"In September we flagged three things. Here's what happened."	Table image	Monthly	Trust; unique	Our database	Low
Case Notes	Proof	Anonymised lessons from real advisory work	The proforma line that almost lost an MSME its first EU order	Text	Fortnightly	Advisory demand	Consulting files (with consent)	Low
Offers	Offer	LEAP cohorts, advisory slots, Incentive Desk	LEAP cohort announcement with syllabus	Any	≤1 in 10 posts	Conversion	—	Low

Removed on purpose

- **Motivational and founder-journey posts** — except a rare, genuinely instructive story.
- **Festival greetings** as standalone posts.
- **"Export product ideas" listicles** — replaced by Market Door.
- **News round-ups without an angle** — the Saturday Brief is the only round-up, and every item in it carries a "so what".
- **Generic tips** ("5 tips to find buyers") — they commoditise the brand.

The Angle Engine: eight questions that turn news into a Maverick Minds post

1. **Who pays and who gains?** Follow the money through the value chain.
2. **Which HS lines?** Name them. If you can't, the story isn't ready.
3. **Which Indian exposure?** The value of India's exports of those lines to that market. Source it.
4. **Which competitor country moves?** Relative change matters more than absolute change.
5. **Which cluster feels it first?** Tirupur, Karur, Coimbatore, Ambur, Tuticorin...
6. **What's the deadline or window?** When does it take effect, and when does it bite?
7. **What does the headline get wrong or leave out?**
8. **What should an exporter do this week?** If there's no action, it's a watchlist item, not a post.

The export intelligence system

Where "seeing around corners" actually comes from

Trade developments pass through a predictable lifecycle. Most export content appears at the last two stages. The Desk works at the first three and adds consequences at the fourth.

STAGE	WHAT EXISTS	TYPICAL SOURCE	WHO COVERS IT TODAY	DESK ROLE
1. Draft	Proposed rule, consultation, investigation initiation	WTO ePing, Federal Register notices, EU "have your say", DGTR initiations, foreign trade-remedy initiations	Almost no one in Indian export content	Draft Watch — early warning
2. Notified	Official instrument published	DGFT notifications and trade notices, CBIC notifications, RBI, Gazette, EU OJ	Tax portals (verbatim)	Fine Print — meaning and action
3. Effective	Rule starts to apply	The same documents, dated	Few	Countdown
4. Enforced	Rejections, duties collected, cases decided	RASFF, FDA refusals, CVD/AD final determinations, court orders	Specialists only	Rejection Watch, Second Order
5. Reported	News coverage	ET, BS, Mint, Reuters	Everyone	Confirmation only
6. Commented	LinkedIn takes, YouTube explainers	Everyone	Saturated	Headline vs Reality when the takes are wrong

The source universe

Tiered by value. P = primary, S = secondary. **Early** = gives a lead time; **Confirm** = verifies.

SOURCE	P/S	SIGNAL	CADENCE	METHOD	WHY IT'S WORTH IT
A · Indian regulatory (core, daily)					
DGFT: notifications, public notices, trade notices, circulars	P	Early/Confirm	Daily, twice (DGFT often uploads late in the day)	Page-change watcher	Scheme rates and extensions, FTP changes, procedure
CBIC: customs tariff and non-tariff notifications, ADD/CVD/safeguard, circulars	P	Confirm	Daily	Page watcher / RSS	Duty changes (scrip demand), input-cost duties
ICEGATE advisories	P	Early	Weekly	Page watcher	Operational changes (e-scrip, filing)
RBI: FEMA notifications, master directions	P	Confirm	Daily	RSS	Realisation, EDPMS, trade finance
DGTR: anti-dumping initiations and findings	P	Early	Weekly	Page watcher	Input costs for Indian manufacturers
PIB (Commerce, Finance, Textiles, MSME, Agriculture)	P	Early	Daily	RSS	Cabinet decisions, scheme launches
Commodity boards and EPCs (APEDA, MPEDA, Spices Board, Tea and Coffee Boards, AEPC, EEPC, Texprocil, CLE, Pharmexcil...)	P/S	Early	Weekly	Email subscriptions → inbox parser	Sector circulars, market advisories
B · Foreign regulatory (the edge, daily or weekly)					
WTO ePing (SPS/TBT notifications)	P	Early	Daily email alerts by HS and market	Email alerts → parser	Draft rules with comment windows. Best early-warning source available, and free.
US Federal Register (USTR, Commerce AD/CVD, CBP, FDA)	P	Early/Confirm	Daily	API search for "India"	Tariffs, CVD cases (including RoDTEP findings), import rules
EU Official Journal, DG TRADE trade defence, Access2Markets	P	Early/Confirm	Daily/weekly	RSS / page watch	CBAM, EUDR, AD cases, FTA implementation
EU RASFF, US FDA import refusals and alerts	P	Enforced	Weekly/monthly	Portal queries	What gets Indian food and agri shipments rejected

SOURCE	P/S	SIGNAL	CADENCE	METHOD	WHY IT'S WORTH IT
UK trade tariff, Trade Remedies Authority, UK CBAM guidance	P	Confirm	Weekly	Page watch	CETA implementation
GCC, UAE and Saudi regulators; China GACC; trade-remedy agencies in Canada, Australia, Turkey, Brazil	P	Early	Weekly	Page watch + manual	Frequent sources of action against Indian goods
C · Data (weekly, monthly)					
Commerce ministry monthly quick estimates; TradeStat / DGCI&S	P	Confirm	Monthly (mid-month)	Download	India's exposure by HS and country
UN Comtrade, ITC Trade Map / Market Access Map / Export Potential Map	P/S	Context	On demand	API / manual	Market sizing, competitor shares, tariffs
Global Trade Alert; WTO trade monitoring	S	Early	Weekly	Manual	Global interventions database
IMF PortWatch	P	Early	Weekly	Manual	Chokepoint transits (Hormuz, Red Sea)
D · Logistics					
Drewry WCI (Thu), Freightos FBX, SCFI (Fri)	S	Early	Weekly	Manual / feeds	Rate direction on Indian lanes
Carrier advisories (surcharges, war-risk, routing); Indian port authorities	P	Early	Daily in disruption, else weekly	Email / page watch	Real cost changes before they hit invoices
E · News and analysis (confirmation, context)					
Business Standard, ET, Mint, FE, BusinessLine, Reuters, Fibre2Fashion	S	Confirm	Daily	Google News RSS queries	What's "reported"; saturation check
GTRI, ICRIER, RIS, CSEP, ORF; law-firm alerts	S	Context	Weekly	RSS / email	Quote, extend, don't duplicate
F · Proprietary (the moat)					
Advisory conversations, Incentive Desk activity, LEAP questions, CHA and forwarder network, association WhatsApp groups	P	Early	Continuous	A 60-second "field note" form	Signals nobody else has: what buyers are asking, where shipments stall. Use only anonymised, with consent; never publish client data or deal terms.

Noise (monitor only to measure saturation)

Unverified WhatsApp forwards · "BIG UPDATE" LinkedIn reposts · SEO blogs (leads only, never sources) · YouTube news recaps · "export leads" pages · Telegram tip channels · AI-generated trade blogs · stock-market commentary on exporter shares.

The exposure line: required on every Signal post

Every Signal post carries one sourced line on how exposed India is. For example: *"India exported [value] of HS [code] to [market] in [period] (source: TradeStat / UN Comtrade)."* This one habit makes the Desk's posts concrete, and it is the hardest thing for casual commentators to copy.

Cluster reference map (starter)

CLUSTER	MAIN EXPORT PRODUCTS	HS CHAPTER / HEADING (INDICATIVE)	TYPICAL SENSITIVITY
Tirupur	Knitted apparel	Ch. 61	US tariff tier, UK CETA, RoSCTL, Bangladesh preferences
Karur	Home textiles, made-ups	Ch. 63	RoSCTL, EU FTA, US tariffs
Coimbatore	Pumps, motors, castings, engineering	8413, 8501, Ch. 73	CBAM (steel content), US Section 232/301, EU FTA
Erode	Turmeric, textiles	0910, Ch. 52/63	SPS limits, RASFF, FDA
Namakkal	Eggs, poultry	0407	Gulf demand, SPS rules, Hormuz shipping

CLUSTER	MAIN EXPORT PRODUCTS	HS CHAPTER / HEADING (INDICATIVE)	TYPICAL SENSITIVITY
Ambur / Vellore / Ranipet	Leather, footwear	Ch. 41, 42, 64	EUDR (leather proposed for exclusion), UK CETA
Tuticorin	Marine products, port-linked trade	Ch. 03	US CVD/AD on shrimp, SPS, freight
Chennai / Hosur	Auto components, electronics	8708, Ch. 85	US tariffs, EU FTA rules of origin

HS mappings are indicative starter tags for the database, not tariff classifications. Confirm product-level codes before publishing any exposure figure.

Daily research system

Every day, the system answers one question: *what happened in global trade today that Indian exporters should know, and which of it can we explain better than anyone?*

The day at the Desk (IST)

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO
05:30	Automated collection sweep. Catches overnight US and EU publications (Federal Register, EU OJ), ePing alerts, late-evening DGFT/CBIC uploads, and news feeds.	Machine
06:30	Dedup, clustering, triage, first-pass scores. The Desk Sheet goes out: top 10 candidates, each with a one-line consequence, sources, score and saturation count.	Machine
07:45	Pick today's lead and one backup (15 minutes). Flag Watchlist items.	Founder or analyst
08:00–09:30	Verification pass (protocol below); run the Angle Engine; pull the exposure figure; machine draft and claims table produced.	Analyst + machine
09:30–10:30	Edit the draft into the founder's voice; build the visual from the template; risk-tier check.	Analyst + designer
10:30	Approval (Part 15)	Founder
11:00–12:30	Publish. Initial time window to test: late morning IST on weekdays. Founder replies to comments in the first hour.	Founder
16:00	Second sweep: afternoon DGFT/CBIC uploads, EU morning publications. Update the Watchlist.	Machine + analyst
21:00	Late check of DGFT/CBIC (evening notifications are common). Anything urgent becomes tomorrow's lead or a same-evening short post.	Machine alert

Speed tiers:

- **T+0** — simple, primary-sourced facts (e.g. an extension notification).
- **T+1 (default)** — anything needing interpretation.
- **T+3 to T+7** — Second Order, Market Door, Rejection Watch.

Being a day later than the tax portals is fine. Being wrong is not.

Weekly and monthly rhythm

Weekly

- Mon: plan the week, update the Countdown calendar
- Thu: Freight Pulse data (Drewry WCI)
- Fri: Brief assembly, Watchlist review, performance review (30 min)
- Sat: Brief published

Monthly

- Mid-month: India trade data → The Number
- RASFF / FDA pull → Rejection Watch
- Calls Ledger grading
- Audience-quality audit (Part 16)
- Scoring-weight review

People (minimum viable desk)

- Founder: 60–90 min a day (pick, voice, approve, comments)
- Research analyst: full-time; commerce, law or economics background; owns verification
- Designer: part-time, working from templates
- Automation: one developer for build, then light maintenance

Verification protocol

1. **Policy, tax, customs and scheme claims** need the primary document open, not a summary of it. Record its number, date and URL.
2. **Numbers** are copied from the source with the exact quoted text stored alongside them. Any derived number (%, growth) is recomputed by the analyst.
3. **Dates** are checked for "effective from" versus "notified on", and converted to IST where relevant.
4. **Two-source rule** for anything not in a primary document: two independent credible outlets, never two outlets repeating one wire story.
5. Every sentence in the draft is tagged **FACT**, **INTERPRETATION**, **FORECAST** or **OPINION** in the claims table. The published post reflects those tags in its language (the uncertainty ladder).
6. **Pre-mortem line**: "What would make this post wrong in a week?" If the answer is plausible, soften the claim or wait.
7. **Legal-interpretation items** (duty liability, eligibility edge cases) get a quick check with a partner CA or customs broker before publishing.

Worked example: one development through the system

CANDIDATE · FEMA EXPORT REGIME CHANGE · 1 OCT 2026

Raw signal: law-firm and compliance articles say the FEMA (Export and Import of Goods and Services) Regulations, 2026 (notified 13 Jan 2026) take effect on 1 October 2026. A June 2026 amendment reset the old regime's realisation period from 15 months to 9.

Verification to-do:

- Open the RBI notification and the Directions.
- Confirm the effective date, the realisation periods (15 months; 18 for INR invoicing) and the transition treatment for shipments made before 1 Oct.
- Check whether banks have issued EDF/EDPMS operating instructions.

Angle Engine:

- *Who gains:* exporters with long credit terms and INR-invoicing exporters.
- *Headline gap:* "15 months" coverage ignores the June–September reversion to 9 months under the old rules. Shipments made in that window may still sit under the old clock. [VERIFY](#)
- *Action:* check which regime governs each open shipping bill; review payment terms on October contracts; ask your AD bank for its EDF process.

Score: 74 while resting on secondary sources; 87 once the RBI text is verified (see Part 12). **Decision:** lead post on 22 Sep and a Countdown item on 28 Sep.

Content scoring model

The goal is not "find an export news article". It is **find the story Maverick Minds can explain better than anyone today**. So the model rewards angle and action as much as importance. It also penalises saturation.

Step 1: Gates (pass all four or discard)

1. **G1 Evidence:** at least one primary source, or two independent credible secondaries.
2. **G2 Indian implication:** an identifiable effect on Indian exporters or importers.
3. **G3 Not a repeat:** we haven't covered it in the last 14 days, unless there is a genuine new development.
4. **G4 No unverifiable numbers:** the core claim doesn't depend on a figure we can't source.

Step 2: Weighted criteria (each scored 0–5)

CRITERION	WEIGHT	5 MEANS...	1 MEANS...
Exporter impact (money, time or risk at stake)	20	Changes price, cash cycle or market access materially	Cosmetic or symbolic
Actionability	15	A clear "do this before [date]"	Nothing to do
Maverick angle strength	15	A second-order insight the headline misses	Only restating the news
Indian exposure (breadth × specificity)	12	Many exporters, or clearly named HS lines and clusters	Vague, "Indian businesses"
Under-coverage (inverse saturation)	12	0–2 Indian items with this angle in 72 h	10+ items with the same angle
Time sensitivity	10	A window closes within 30 days	No time element
Explainability	6	Clear in one post and one visual	Needs a report
Audience–business fit	5	Core segments (Part 6)	Outside our audiences
Evidence quality	5	Primary document in hand	Only secondary

Base score = Σ (weight × score ÷ 5), out of 100.

Final score = base × confidence multiplier (1.0 primary-verified; 0.85 credible secondary pending verification) – penalties.

Penalties:

- –5 for geopolitical or political sensitivity.
- –5 to –15 when the story needs speculation to be interesting.
- –10 for a near-repeat.

Conflict of interest (scrip-related) is not penalised. It triggers a mandatory disclosure line instead.

FINAL SCORE	DECISION
≥ 75	Lead Signal: today's post; consider a carousel
60–74	Secondary post or Saturday Brief item
45–59	Watchlist, with a named trigger for revisiting

FINAL SCORE	DECISION
< 45	Discard (logged, so we learn what we skip)

Saturation check (automatable): count Indian news items and LinkedIn posts from the last 72 hours matching the story's entities and angle, from a Google News RSS query plus a manual LinkedIn search.

- 0–2 items scores 5.
- 3–10 items scores 3.
- More than 10 items scores 1, unless our angle differs, in which case score the angle, not the topic.

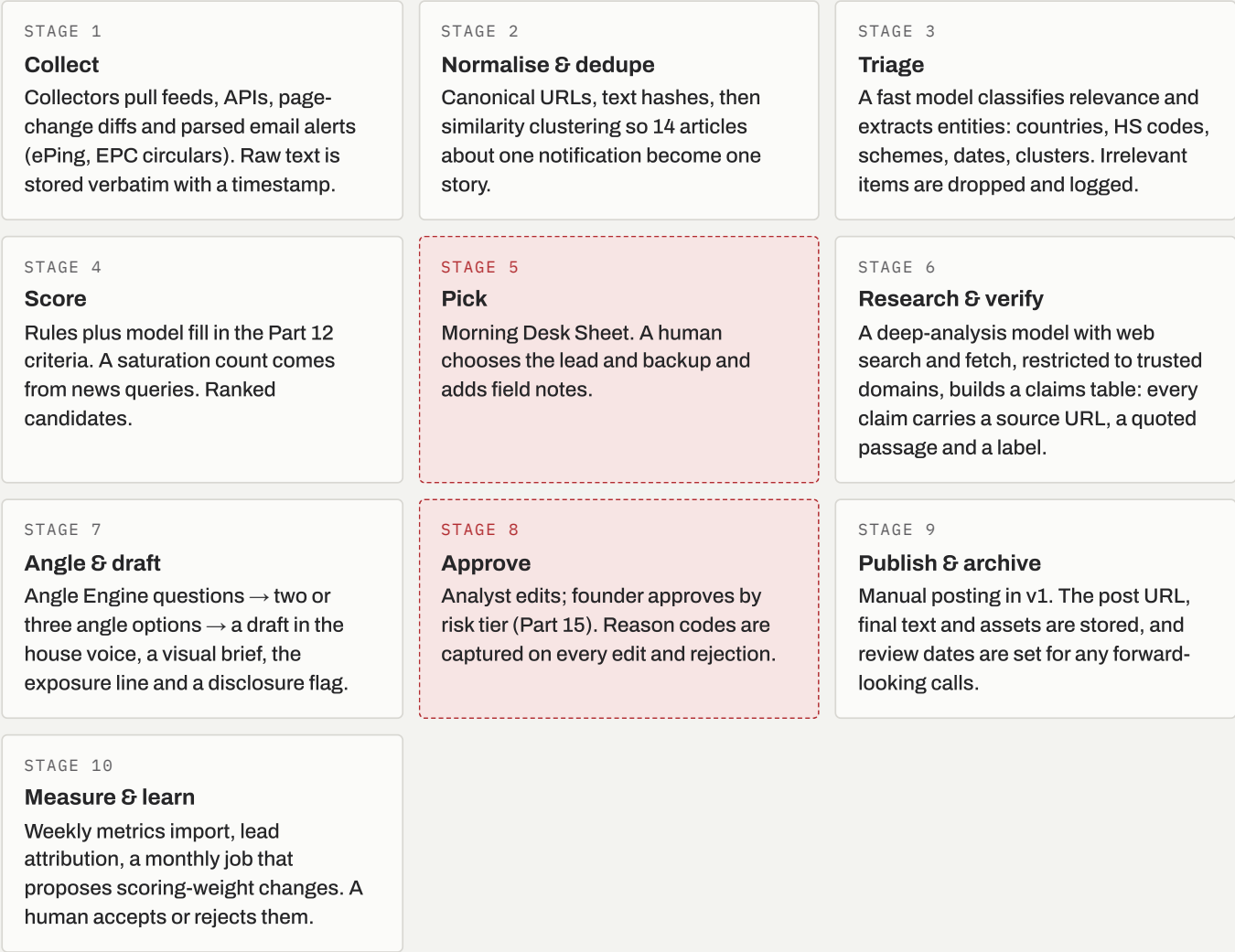
Worked scoring: five real candidates (as of 14 Sep 2026)

CANDIDATE	IMPACT	ACTION	ANGLE	EXPOSURE	UNDER-COV.	TIME	EXPLAIN	FIT	EVID.	BASE	FINAL	DECISION
RoDTEP/RoSCTL extension ends 30 Sep: price October quotes as if the benefit were zero	5	4	4	5	3	5	4	5	5	88.0	88	Lead · disclosure required
FEMA 2026 regulations effective 1 Oct	4	5	4	5	4	5	4	4	4	87.4	74 → 87	Lead once RBI text is verified
US final CVD, oleoresin paprika from India (FR, 21 Aug 2026)	3	3	5	2	5	3	3	3	5	70.4	70	Secondary. Broaden to "RoDTEP in US CVD cases" to lift exposure → ~75.
Hormuz: Gulf freight costs (restated)	4	3	3	4	2	4	3	3	3	66.0	51	Watchlist as-is
Same story, with the Incoterm angle ("stop quoting CIF to Gulf buyers")	4	5	5	4	2	4	3	3	3	78.0	61	Secondary post. The angle alone moved it 10 points.
August trade data release (headline numbers)	2	1	2	4	1	4	4	3	5	49.8	50	Watchlist. Post only if a line-level anomaly appears.

Hormuz rows: $\text{base} \times 0.85$ (secondary sources) – 5 (sensitivity). FEMA: $\times 0.85$ until verified. The weights are a starting hypothesis; Part 16 describes how they get recalibrated from outcomes.

Automation architecture

Principle: automate collection, sorting and first drafts; keep a human on choice, truth and publication. Stages run in this order. The dashed stages are human gates.



Recommended stack

LAYER	PHASE 1 (WEEKS 1–6)	PHASE 2 (MONTHS 2–4)
Runtime and schedule	Python scripts on the office Windows machine via Task Scheduler (05:30, 16:00, 21:00)	Cloud cron (e.g. GitHub Actions), or Claude Managed Agents scheduled deployments, so it doesn't depend on one PC
Storage	SQLite file + daily backup	Postgres (e.g. Supabase) with the same schema (Part 14)
Collectors	RSS/Atom (feedparser); Federal Register API; page-change diff for DGFT, CBIC, RBI, DGTR; IMAP parser for ePing and EPC emails; Google News RSS queries	+ UN Comtrade API for the exposure line; RASFF and FDA monthly pulls
Triage model	Claude Haiku 4.5 (claude-haiku-4-5). Overnight items go through the Message Batches API at 50% cost.	Same; tuned on reason codes from rejections
Analysis and drafting model	Claude Opus 5 (claude-opus-5) with adaptive thinking; server tools web_search_20260209 / web_fetch_20260209 restricted with allowed_domains for verification runs; structured outputs for the claims table	+ prompt caching of the stable voice guide, franchise templates and examples (cuts repeat input cost)

LAYER	PHASE 1 (WEEKS 1–6)	PHASE 2 (MONTHS 2–4)
Review surface	Desk Sheet emailed at 06:30; approval queue in a shared Google Sheet (status column, reason code, approver)	A small web dashboard: queue, claims table with source links, one-click approve or return
Publishing	Manual on LinkedIn (founder); Meta Business Suite scheduling for Instagram	Scheduling tools allowed only for <i>approved</i> items. Still no auto-publish.
Metrics	Weekly CSV export from LinkedIn and Instagram analytics; UTM links; a lead form with a "which post brought you?" field	Automated imports where APIs allow

Guardrails built into the pipeline

- **No claim without a quote.** The structured output schema *requires* `source_url` and `source_quote` for every numeric, date or rule claim. Drafts citing a claim not in the table are rejected automatically.
- **"Unknown" is a valid answer.** Prompts tell the model to leave a field empty rather than infer a rate, date or value.
- **Fetches pages are data, not instructions.** Text from the web is passed as quoted content, and the model is told never to follow instructions found inside it. Verification fetches are domain-restricted.
- **Recency check.** Every claim records the document date. Anything older than the latest amendment in the database is flagged "possibly superseded".
- **Disclosure trigger.** Any story tagged RoDTEP, RoSCTL, scrip or duty credit automatically gets the disclosure line in its draft.
- **Repeat detection.** Similarity search against the last 90 days of posts; near-duplicates are flagged before scoring.
- **Human approval required** at stages 5 and 8. The system has no credentials to publish anything.

Why not auto-publish?

OPINION The brand's entire value is accuracy and judgement. One auto-published misreading of a customs notification would cost more trust than a year of daily posts earns. It also creates a quiet liability: exporters may act on it. The only thing worth considering for automation later is *scheduling* an already-approved post. Even the weekly Freight Pulse chart should get a 30-second human glance.

Running cost (order of magnitude)

ESTIMATE At list prices, assuming the following daily volumes:

- **Triage:** about 300 items a day on Haiku 4.5 (\$1 / \$5 per million input/output tokens, half price via Batches).
- **Deep analysis:** about 5 stories a day on Opus 5 (\$5 / \$25), with roughly 40K tokens in and 5K out each.
- **Drafting:** 2 drafts a day.

Model spend comes to roughly US\$75–150 a month before web-search tool charges and thinking tokens. Measure real usage from the API's usage fields in week one before trusting this figure. People, not models, are the real cost: the analyst is the essential hire.

Build sequence

WHEN	DELIVERABLE
Weeks 1–2	Manual desk: source list, alert subscriptions (ePing, Federal Register, EPCs), Google Sheet database, templates. Publishing starts now; automation catches up.
Weeks 3–6	Collectors + SQLite + dedup + the 06:30 Desk Sheet email
Weeks 7–12	Triage and scoring model; claims-table research runs; draft generation; approval queue
Months 4–6	Metrics import, Calls Ledger automation, learning job, WhatsApp channel distribution, Postgres migration

Content memory: database design

The database is the Desk's memory. It stops repeats, powers the Ledger, shows which angles earn qualified attention, and becomes the raw material for LEAP. The schema covers every field the brief asked for and adds the ones that make learning possible.

```

-- Sources we monitor
sources(id, name, url, kind[primary|secondary], signal_type[early|confirm|enforced|context],
        cadence, method[rss|api|pagewatch|email|manual], country, reliability_1to5, active)

-- Everything collected, verbatim
raw_items(id, source_id, url, canonical_url, title, body_text, published_at, collected_at,
          content_hash, language)

-- One story = a cluster of raw items about one development
stories(id, title, first_seen_at, source_published_at, primary_source_url,
        primary_doc_ref,          -- e.g. "Notification No. 74/2025-26-DGFT"
        topic_category, lifecycle_stage[draft|notified|effective|enforced|reported],
        countries[], hs_codes[], industries[], clusters[], schemes[],
        effective_date, deadline_date,
        score_base, confidence_mult, penalties, score_final, score_breakdown_json,
        saturation_count_72h, decision[lead|secondary|brief|watchlist|discard],
        decision_reason, watch_trigger, revisit_on,
        previously_covered bool, related_story_ids[], similarity_max)
story_items(story_id, raw_item_id)

-- Atomic claims with evidence
claims(id, story_id, text, claim_type[fact|interpretation|forecast|opinion|speculation],
        source_url, source_quote, source_date, verified_by, verified_at,
        status[verified|pending|failed|superseded])

-- Drafts and versions
drafts(id, story_id, version, franchise, angle, hook, body, format, visual_brief,
        exposure_line, disclosure_required bool, risk_tier[green|amber|red],
        model_used, created_at, edited_by, edit_reason_codes[])

-- What actually went out
posts(id, draft_id, channel[linkedin_founder|linkedin_page|instagram|newsletter|whatsapp],
        language, published_at, url, final_text, format, cta_type,
        audience_segment, funnel_role, commercial_line[none|leap|advisory|incentive],
        status[scheduled|published|corrected|withdrawn])
post_metrics(post_id, captured_at, impressions, reactions, comments, reposts, saves, sends,
             profile_visits, link_clicks, follows, dwell_or_watch_time,
             qualified_comments, qualified_engagers_sampled, qualified_share)

-- Accountability
calls_ledger(id, post_id, call_text, confidence_word[likely|possible], made_on, review_on,
             outcome_text, grade[right|partly|wrong|unresolved], graded_on, graded_by)
corrections(id, post_id, error_text, correction_text, corrected_at, root_cause)

-- Commercial attribution
leads(id, created_at, name_hash, segment, channel, source_post_id, self_reported_source,
       intent[leap|advisory|incentive_sell|incentive_buy|campus|other], stage, value_band)

-- Learning and landscape
approvals(id, draft_id, approver, decision, reason_code, decided_at, time_to_decide_min)
competitor_posts(id, account, archetype, posted_at, topic, format, hook_type,
                 reactions, comments, reposts, sample_commenter_mix_json)
learnings(id, period, finding, evidence_json, action, weight_change_json, accepted bool)

```

Why the extra fields matter

FIELD	WHAT IT ENABLES
lifecycle_stage, source_published_at vs published_at	Measures lead time: how early the Desk is relative to the document and to media coverage. This is the "saw it first" metric.

FIELD	WHAT IT ENABLES
claims.claim_type, source_quote	Audit trail; the fact/interpretation discipline; defence if challenged
revisit_on, watch_trigger, calls_ledger	Follow-ups and the public Ledger. Turns one story into a series.
hs_codes[], clusters[], schemes[]	"What have we said about Ch. 61 this quarter?"; LEAP module assembly; cluster newsletters
edit_reason_codes, approvals.reason_code	Trains the drafting prompts on what the founder always changes
qualified_share, leads.source_post_id	Optimises for audience quality and business, not likes
disclosure_required, risk_tier	Compliance and trust controls you can prove
decision = discard (logged)	Checks whether skipped topics later became big. This calibrates the scoring model.

Approval workflow

Approval effort scales with risk. Most posts need five minutes of founder time.

A few need a second pair of eyes.

RISK TIER	WHAT FALLS IN IT	REQUIRED BEFORE PUBLISHING	APPROVER
Green	Evergreen and news-pegged explainers; Freight Pulse; Ask the Desk on settled questions	Claims table complete; analyst self-check	Analyst; founder spot-checks weekly
Amber	Interpreting policy, data or FTAs; Countdowns; Second Order; Headline vs Reality	Primary document verified; every numeric claim quoted; interpretation labelled; pre-mortem line	Founder
Red	Anything about incentives or scrips, duty liability, eligibility, legal interpretation, named companies, trade-remedy cases, geopolitics	All Amber checks + disclosure line (if scrip-related) + partner CA or customs-broker check for legal points + wording review against the uncertainty ladder	Founder + external check

Pre-publish checklist (10 items)

1. Primary source opened and its number, date and link recorded.
2. Every number traceable to a quoted source line.
3. "Effective" versus "notified" dates correct.
4. Interpretation, forecast and opinion signalled in the language.
5. HS lines, markets and clusters named correctly.
6. An action is present, or the item is moved to the Watchlist.
7. Disclosure line present if scrip, RoDTEP or RoSCTL is involved.
8. No banned phrases; no income or outcome claims.
9. Visual matches the text (no chart implying more precision than the data has).
10. Any forward-looking call logged in the Calls Ledger with a review date.

Service levels and escalation

- Lead post approved by 10:30 IST. If it isn't, the backup Green item runs, and nothing unapproved goes out.
- Breaking primary-source news (e.g. a scheme extension notification) can use a **fast lane**: a factual-only post (what the document says, a link, "analysis tomorrow"), approved in 15 minutes.
- **Corrections**: within 24 hours of detection. Edit the post, add a "Correction:" comment, and log a corrections row with its root cause. Review root causes monthly.

Performance and learning loop

North-star metric: qualified conversations per month. These are inbound DMs, calls or forms from people who export, import or have a real product and an intent to export, attributed to content. Likes are a diagnostic, never a goal.

LAYER	METRICS	HOW TO MEASURE
Reputation	Qualified share of new followers and engagers; saves and sends per 1,000 impressions; reposts by credible accounts (EPC staff, association office-bearers, bankers, journalists); citations and invitations; lead time versus media coverage	Monthly audit: sample 50 new engagers and classify them (exporter / importer / MSME / service provider / student / other)
Habit	Newsletter subscribers and open rate; WhatsApp channel members; returning engagers (people who engage 3+ times a month)	Newsletter and WhatsApp stats; engager log
Pipeline	Diagnostic bookings; LEAP waitlist and cohort sign-ups; advisory enquiries; Incentive Desk enquiries (sell and buy split)	Lead form with "which post brought you here?"; UTM links; the leads table
Quality	Correction rate; Ledger hit rate (right / partly / wrong); claims failing verification at approval	Database
Efficiency	Minutes of founder time per post; time from document to post	Approvals log

The loop

- Weekly (30 min, Friday).** Top and bottom three posts by qualified engagement, not reach. For each, ask what in the franchise, angle, format or hook explains the result. Kill or keep one experiment.
- Monthly (90 min).**
 - Audience-quality audit.
 - Ledger grading.
 - Score calibration:** compare each post's predicted score with its realised qualified engagement and leads. If "Under-coverage" predicts outcomes better than "Time sensitivity", the learning job proposes shifting weight between them. A human accepts or rejects the change.
- Quarterly.**
 - Revisit segments and franchises.
 - Retire any franchise below the median for two consecutive months.
 - Reconsider cadence.
 - Review the Incentive Desk against scheme developments.

Rules that stop the loop optimising the wrong thing

- Never let a reach-winning format displace a franchise that produces leads.
- Viral posts with a low qualified share are treated as a *warning*, not a win. They pull the audience off-target.
- Compare posts only within their franchise. A Countdown and a Second Order do different jobs.

First-90-day targets (to calibrate, not to promise)

- At least 40% of sampled new engagers in target segments.
- At least 4 Calls Ledger entries graded publicly.
- At least 10 qualified conversations a month by day 90.
- Correction rate under 1 in 30 posts.
- A LEAP waitlist built only from the newsletter and WhatsApp.

Adjust after month two, once there's real baseline data.

30-day editorial plan · 15 Sep – 14 Oct 2026

This plan puts the strategy into practice. It is built around **real dated events**, called *anchors*. The other days are *slots* that hold a pre-researched candidate, replaced whenever the scoring model surfaces something stronger that morning. Every headline is a *working* headline. Nothing publishes until its "verify" column is done.

Totals: 22 founder LinkedIn posts, 4 Saturday Briefs, about 13 Instagram pieces, and 4 Sundays kept for Watchlist review.

DATE	TYPE	LINKEDIN LEAD: FRANCHISE · WORKING HEADLINE · ANGLE	VERIFY BEFORE PUBLISHING	INSTAGRAM / OTHER
Tue 15 Sep	Anchor	Countdown (launch). "Three dates in the next 17 days that change an Indian exporter's paperwork": 30 Sep (RoDTEP/RoSCTL extension ends), 30 Sep–1 Oct (G20 trade ministerial; US–India talks), 1 Oct (FEMA 2026 regime). Closes with two lines on what the Desk will do here.	RBI text for the FEMA effective date; G20 dates; any DGFT notice that morning	Reel: "What this account does now" (founder, Tamil + English captions)
Wed 16 Sep	Slot	The Number <i>if</i> August trade data is out: one line-level move linked to Hormuz or the US 10% tier. <i>Fallback:</i> Second Order on RoDTEP in US CVD cases.	Commerce ministry release; compute changes yourself	—
Thu 17 Sep	Slot	Freight Pulse #1. "Quoting CIF to a Gulf buyer during the Hormuz closure means underwriting war-risk you can't price." Incoterm and insurance actions.	Carrier surcharge notices; current routing status; war-risk cover availability	Carousel: "FOB vs CIF when the sea gets dangerous"
Fri 18 Sep	Slot	Headline vs Reality. "UK CETA, two months in: '99% of lines duty-free'. Where Indian products actually gained margin, and against whom." Three example lines.	UK tariff before and after for each line; which competitors already had UK preferences	—
Sat 19 Sep	Anchor	The Maverick Brief #1 (newsletter launch): the week's five items with "so what", the Countdown, "what we're watching".	Every item's source line	Paperwork, Decoded #1: the shipping bill
Sun 20 Sep	—	No post. Watchlist review; prepare the RoDTEP scenario drafts.		
Mon 21 Sep	Anchor	Countdown. "9 days: RoDTEP and RoSCTL. What to do with shipping bills, e-scrips and October quotes." Angle INTERPRETATION : price October quotes as if the benefit were zero and treat any extension as upside; generate pending e-scrips; check ARR status. <i>Disclosure line.</i> Red tier.	DGFT and Textiles Ministry for new notices; ICEGATE validity rule; ARR threshold	Reel: "RoDTEP in 60 seconds" (Tamil)
Tue 22 Sep	Anchor	The Fine Print. "From 1 October: 15 months to realise exports (18 if you invoice in rupees). And the part most coverage skips: the 9-month window since June." Amber/Red tier.	RBI regulations and Directions; transition treatment for pre-October shipments	—
Wed 23 Sep	Slot	Second Order. "Your RoDTEP benefit can be counted against you in a US countervailing duty case." The 21 Aug 2026 final CVD on oleoresin paprika from India, plus earlier cases. What to keep on file.	Federal Register notice and Issues & Decision Memo: confirm RoDTEP is listed as countervailable in that case	Is This Real? #1: the fake letter of credit
Thu 24 Sep	Slot	Draft Watch #1. The highest-exposure SPS/TBT draft notified this month that affects a major Indian export (e.g. residue limits or labelling), with its comment deadline and what to ask your buyer.	ePing notification ID, product scope, comment deadline	—
Fri 25 Sep	Slot	Ask the Desk. "If RoDTEP isn't extended, what happens to scrips I already hold and shipments I've already made?" <i>Disclosure line.</i>	Scrip validity; how the extension notification words its cut-off	One Word: "war-risk surcharge"
Sat 26 Sep	Anchor	Brief #2	Source lines	—
Sun 27 Sep	—	No post. Finalise the 30 Sep scenario drafts (A: same-rate extension · B: extension with changes · C: lapse or transition · D: no announcement).		
Mon 28 Sep	Anchor	Countdown (week ahead). 30 Sep scheme expiry · G20 trade ministerial opens 30 Sep · FEMA 2026 on 1 Oct · EUDR in 93 days.	Dates; latest DGFT notices	—
Tue 29 Sep	Anchor	Countdown special. "92 days: what your EU buyer will ask coffee and rubber exporters for (and why leather may be off the hook)."	Current EUDR text and the status of the simplification package and leather scope proposal	Carousel: EUDR in seven slides
Wed 30 Sep	Anchor · reactive	Scheme decision day. Publish only what is notified, via the fast lane: the matching scenario post (A/B/C/D) with actions for tomorrow's shipping bills. <i>Disclosure line.</i> If nothing is out by evening, post scenario D and check again at 21:00.	DGFT and Textiles Ministry notifications, including late uploads	—

DATE	TYPE	LINKEDIN LEAD: FRANCHISE · WORKING HEADLINE · ANGLE	VERIFY BEFORE PUBLISHING	INSTAGRAM / OTHER
Thu 1 Oct	Anchor	The Fine Print (day one). "New FEMA rules are live: five questions to ask your AD bank this week" (EDF, set-off, third-party receipts, INR invoicing). If the scheme notice landed late on 30 Sep, it takes this slot instead.	RBI Directions; bank circulars if available	Reel: "What changed today" (Tamil)
Fri 2 Oct	Anchor	Calls Ledger #1 (September). The flags we made (scheme scenarios, the FEMA transition, the Gulf Incoterm call) and what happened. Gandhi Jayanti, so keep it short.	Outcomes against sources	—
Sat 3 Oct	Anchor	Brief #3 , including any outcome from the G20 ministerial and US–India talks	Official readouts only	Paperwork, Decoded #2: certificate of origin
Sun 4 Oct	—	No post.		
Mon 5 Oct	Slot (event-linked)	Headline vs Reality. "A preferential rate versus competitors': India's US tariff position against Vietnam, Bangladesh and China for knitwear, home textiles and pumps."	Each country's current US rate from USTR / Federal Register; don't estimate	—
Tue 6 Oct	Slot	The Fine Print. "Your EU buyer is pricing a 2026 carbon cost that gets paid in 2027." CBAM on steel articles and castings, plus UK CBAM from 1 Jan 2027. Coimbatore foundry angle.	EU CBAM certificate timeline; UK CBAM scope and date	60-Second Desk: CBAM with one invoice
Wed 7 Oct	Slot	Rejection Watch #1. "What the EU flagged from India in September": products, hazards, patterns, and what exporters in those lines should check.	RASFF data pull; count twice; no named firms unless in the public record	—
Thu 8 Oct	Slot	Freight Pulse #3. Gulf, Red Sea and EU lanes: rates, transit, surcharges.	Index values and carrier notices	Is This Real? #2: advance-fee "buyers"
Fri 9 Oct	Slot	Headline vs Reality. "Bangladesh's LDC graduation won't strip its EU apparel access this year. Tirupur should plan for 2029, not 2026."	UN CDP / UNGA decision on the deferral request; EU EBA transition terms	—
Sat 10 Oct	Anchor	Brief #4 , with the first soft LEAP line: "We're building LEAP from this Desk. Join the waitlist."	Source lines	—
Sun 11 Oct	—	No post. Monthly review prep: audience audit and score calibration.		
Mon 12 Oct	Anchor	Countdown. EUDR in 79 days · UK CBAM in 81 days · India–EU FTA signature steps.	Council / Commission status	—
Tue 13 Oct	Slot	Market Door #1. One UK CETA tariff line where Indian goods now enter duty-free, with UK import demand, main suppliers and the rules of origin to meet.	Tariff line; Trade Map / Comtrade figures; product-specific rules	Carousel version for Instagram
Wed 14 Oct	Slot	Case Note #1 (only if a consented, anonymised case exists). <i>Fallback:</i> Ask the Desk #2 from September's inbox.	Client consent; anonymisation	Reality Check: "Who exporting is not for (yet)"

URGENT, OUTSIDE THE CONTENT PLAN · THIS WEEK

The Incentive Desk needs its own plan for **30 SEP 2026**, whatever happens:

- Tell exporter clients to generate pending e-scrips.
- Review open buy and sell positions against each scenario.
- Prepare client communications for scenarios A–D.

Do this privately and directly with clients, not in the public feed.

Next steps

1. **Decide** on the positioning, the founder byline and the Desk name (this week).
2. **Set up** the free alerts today: ePing (HS chapters of priority clusters × key markets), Federal Register saved search for "India", DGFT and CBIC page watchers, EPC newsletters, Google News queries.
3. **Hire or assign** the research analyst. This is the critical dependency.
4. **Run the 14-day competitor audit** (Part 3) alongside the first two weeks of posting.

5. **Publish** the 15 Sep Countdown. The automation build (Part 13) starts in parallel and doesn't delay publishing.

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Primary sources are preferred; secondary sources are marked with Verify labels in the text where they carry a claim. Nothing here comes from files previously held by Maverick Minds.

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Prepared for Maverick Minds · 14 September 2026 · Draft for founder review. Scheme, tariff and regulatory statements reflect sources available on the research date. Re-verify every item before publication.